

(245) Legal Office Procedures

Description & Eligibility

Evaluate knowledge of legal terminology and skills needed to prepare legal documents and function effectively in a law office. Any postsecondary or secondary division contestant may enter this application event.

Contestant Must Supply

- Published and/or unpublished non-electronic written reference materials
- Cordless calculator: Electronic devices will be monitored according to ACT standards. See *NLC Calculator Guidelines*. Contestants who violate this rule will be *disqualified*.

Equipment/Supplies Provided

- Computer and software

Competition Notes

- Method of evaluation: application.
- All student-produced jobs completed on-site are uploaded electronically and are not printed at the national level.
- Previous Business Professionals of America tests and/or sample tests (handwritten, photocopied or keyed) may not be taken into the testing area. **Violation of this rule will result in disqualification.**
- Length of event: no more than ten (10) minutes orientation, no more than ninety (60) minutes testing time, and no more than ten (10) minutes wrap-up.
- Entries vary by state.

Contest Competencies

- Demonstrate knowledge of the basic terminology and office procedures needed to work effectively in a legal environment
- Apply technical skills to produce a variety of office/legal documents
- Provide customer support and service
- Monitor and respond to electronic mail
- Prepare and maintain inventory of equipment and supplies
- Maintain filing systems (alphabetical, subject, numerical, and chronological) using ARMA rules
- Demonstrate understanding of legal terminology and Latin words pertaining to legal terminology
- Use correct format in drafting client correspondence and legal documents, including affidavits, interrogatories, final judgement, and power of attorney
- Research and locate legal information and records
- Maintain client account records and prepare billing statements
- Demonstrate knowledge of federal, state, and local court structures and proceedings
- Identify ethical responsibilities of the legal profession
- Maintain electronic files